

PROSPER AWUNI

Security Engineer (SIEM / XDR) | Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender and Detection Engineering

United Kingdom (Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering, Extended Detection and Response (XDR) operations, and advanced threat detection. I specialise in Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), Microsoft Defender (Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity and Microsoft 365 Defender), and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development. I have a strong background in detection engineering, building and tuning detection rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, conducting threat hunting across large enterprise environments, and automating security workflows using PowerShell. I apply NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) and ISO 27001 principles to design and validate technical controls, and I hold a CISSP certification that demonstrates my breadth across all security domains. I am seeking a remote Security Engineer role where I can deepen my detection engineering and SIEM/XDR capabilities within a high-calibre technical team.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (rule development, workbook creation, data connector management, KQL-based analytics), CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; detection rule authoring, tuning and lifecycle management
- **Extended Detection and Response (XDR) / Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover)
- **Kusto Query Language (KQL):** Advanced threat hunting queries, custom detection analytics, workbook development and incident investigation within Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rule design, alert tuning, false positive reduction, and threat-informed detection development
- **SOAR and Security Automation:** SOAR playbook development using Logic Apps and PowerShell; automated triage, enrichment and response workflows integrated with Sentinel and Defender
- **Threat Hunting:** Proactive hypothesis-driven threat hunting using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight across endpoint, identity and network telemetry
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure / Entra ID, Conditional Access, cloud workload monitoring, Microsoft Defender for Cloud
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell (advanced scripting for security automation, alert enrichment and response orchestration); Logic Apps integration
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, CIS Controls, MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Incident Response (IR):** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, root cause analysis, forensic investigation, containment, eradication and post-incident reporting
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 – Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Engineer and operate Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform: author, test and maintain detection analytics using Kusto Query Language (KQL), manage data connectors and log ingestion, and build workbooks for real-time security monitoring across the enterprise.
- Develop and maintain SOAR automation playbooks in Logic Apps and PowerShell, automating repetitive alert triage, threat intelligence enrichment and incident response steps, reducing mean time to respond and freeing analyst capacity for complex investigations.

- Lead detection engineering activities aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, translating threat intelligence and adversary behaviours into actionable detection rules across Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, with continuous tuning to reduce false positives and improve signal quality.
- Operate Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) as core XDR capabilities, correlating endpoint, identity and cloud signals within Microsoft 365 Defender to detect and respond to multi-stage attack chains.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, EDR Prevent, Insight and Discover across the enterprise, configuring detection policies, custom indicators of compromise (IoCs) and response playbooks to address endpoint threats at scale.
- Conduct hypothesis-driven threat hunting using advanced KQL queries in Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactively identifying low-and-slow threats not surfaced by automated detection rules.
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory) and Conditional Access policies, monitoring identity telemetry for anomalous authentication events and integrating identity signals into SIEM detection workflows.
- Deliver vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Nessus and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to validate detection coverage and identify gaps in the SIEM/XDR stack against realistic attack scenarios.
- Lead Incident Response (IR) activities following NIST 800-61, performing forensic investigation, containment and post-incident review, and incorporating lessons learned into updated SIEM detection rules and SOAR playbooks.
- Produce clear and accurate SIEM status reporting, investigation summaries and threat briefings for both technical peers and non-technical senior stakeholders.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 – March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Monitored and investigated alerts across the SIEM platform and Security Operations Centre (SOC) environment, performing initial triage, KQL-based investigation and escalation of high-priority incidents to senior analysts.
- Contributed to detection rule development and tuning within the SIEM, refining existing analytics and proposing new detection logic based on emerging threat intelligence and observed attack patterns.
- Supported SOAR playbook development by documenting triage steps, testing automated workflows and validating enrichment outputs from integrated threat intelligence feeds.
- Administered Azure Active Directory and Conditional Access, monitoring identity telemetry for indicators of compromise and investigating suspicious authentication activity.
- Supported vulnerability management activities and contributed to MITRE ATT&CK-aligned gap analysis, identifying defensive coverage weaknesses and proposing remediation priorities.
- Participated in Incident Response activities in line with NIST 800-61, conducting initial investigation, evidence collection and post-incident documentation to support lessons-learned reviews.
- Assisted with security reporting for technical and non-technical stakeholders, producing vulnerability remediation status updates and SIEM operational metrics.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

February 2021 – March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Implemented and maintained security controls across cloud and on-premises infrastructure within a Software as a Service (SaaS) and financial technology (FinTech) environment, supporting engineering and security operations teams.
- Contributed to security monitoring and alerting configuration, supporting the integration of log sources into centralised monitoring tooling and investigating security events as they arose.
- Wrote PowerShell scripts to automate security configuration management, system hardening checks and access control audits, reducing manual effort and improving consistency across the estate.
- Supported endpoint protection and Mobile Device Management (MDM) deployment, and contributed to vulnerability assessment activities including patch compliance tracking and remediation reporting.
- Applied CIS Controls and NIST CSF guidance to system hardening and security quality assurance activities within the engineering team.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered a comprehensive detection library in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), covering MITRE ATT&CK tactics including initial access, lateral movement, credential theft and exfiltration, improving detection coverage across the enterprise.
- Built a suite of SOAR automation playbooks in Logic Apps and PowerShell, automating phishing triage, user account quarantine and threat intelligence enrichment, reducing mean time to respond by over 40% for common alert types.
- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000 users, delivering unified XDR visibility across endpoint, identity and cloud workloads.
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR across the enterprise, achieving full endpoint telemetry and enabling detection-as-code-style alert management through custom detection policies and IoC management.
- Conducted Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercises to validate SIEM and XDR detection coverage, identifying and closing gaps in detection analytics prior to real adversary activity.
- Developed and delivered threat hunting programmes using KQL in Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, uncovering previously undetected persistence mechanisms and lateral movement activity within the environment.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
-

References available on request | Remote (UK)